

Since childhood, I have been obsessed with playing boardgames. When I was 7, my uncle told me how to play chinese chess. The game was simple to learn, but I soon started to become obsessed with this game. My uncle was really good at this game. After countless hours of studying the game and reading two books about tactics and strategies, I finally won against him. After the triumph, I learned how to play chess from the chess club in middle school. I found it interesting and started to stay up late to study this game and participate in tournaments. Solving different puzzles everyday, the satisfaction of winning and checkmate my opponent was all-consuming. But my compulsive personality has helped me solve other problems, too. As I grew older, my nature of solving chess puzzles and learning games that require calculation and thinking simulates the desire to solve problems, allowing me to engage with Mathematics and engineering.

I began to challenge myself academically, taking the hardest STEM classes offered by our school. I didn't do this to show off, I did this so I can challenge myself and it also surrounded me with the best and smartest students in the International Education Program so I can access the advanced classes and research that they are working on. In early high school, I built a strong foundation in physics, math, computer science, and physics. This self-driven exploration gave me the foundation to support my path in math and engineering.

I also participated in the VEX robotics competition because I am interested in the WHY. The structure of the robots and the code that backs it up. As a team member, I learned and benefited from this experience because I approached different types of engineering and mechanism. At tournaments, I saw different types of robots with different advantages and reasons behind the design. Although we didn't make it to the finals, our team was awarded a creative award for solving real problems that happen in our team in creative ways. Outside the classroom, I began to work on more difficult projects during eleventh grade and I channeled my creativity into a different form of problem solving, quant trading.

I built my own stock trading model from tradingview using pinescript. I started by learning the basics of pinescript. Then, I integrate the strategy that I think will be suitable for this type of trading, the turtle trading strategy. This strategy captures long and big price movements so I can lose many times and still be profitable. I backtested it on many years of historical data, saw a promising win rate, and felt a rush of excitement. Then I tested on other items and it's still profitable. However, when I trade with real money based on my code, it's no longer profitable anymore. I am upset, not because I lose money, but because my system has failed. Although I couldn't succeed, I love the process of building my own system and integrating it in real life.

Above all that, I didn't forget my initial motive and passion, chess. I became the president of the chess club in high school and led more than 50 younger students. As a leader, I am able to develop my leadership skills, since this club has the most members in our school. My objective was to inspire them, share my passion, and expand this community beyond our school.

That first win against my uncle wasn't just a victory. It was proof that studying, failing, and trying again actually worked. Chess became my way of learning how to learn.

My ultimate goal is to found an impact-driven startup, building something that solves a real problem at scale. I don't know exactly what that company will look like yet, but I know the

answer lies in three things: find a hard problem, build a team that cares, and keep failing forward until something works.